

Ravens Darkly

A Collection of Haiku Poems

by
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*Haiku means playful verse. I write in the Zen Haiku tradition.
Each of the poems found here reflect a direct experience in
Nature in which the poet disappears into the suchness of what's
arising in the now.*

To the One within All.



Grey dawn. . .

*ravens croaking darkly to each other
above the forest.*

*No wind in the silent green hemlocks. . .
just the sound of unseen
raven's wings.*

*Sunlight breaks through the clouds. . .
revealing dew
sparkling
in tangled grasses.*

*Crystal dew
glistening in sunlight. . .
just dissolves
completely away.*

*With each step that glossy raven
thrusts his great beak
into the world.*

*Eagles dancing in midair. . .
yellow talons reach
for yellow talons.*

*The graceful tip
of the that towering hemlock tree
simply bows over.*

*Suddenly in sunlight,
hundreds of ants
floating
on translucent wings.*

*That sunlit blue dragonfly. . .
changes her direction
in an instant !*

*Duck pops up on the pond's smooth surface
rippling out
concentric circles.*



*A glimpse of black wasp startles me !
startling
the yellow banded wasp.*

*Windy. . .a seed sail
caught in this spider's web
is shaking the whole thing.*

*On a slender strand of invisible silk,
spider
climbs the blue sky.*

*Surrounded by swaying forest. . .
chirpling birds hide
in sudden silence.*

*High in the swinging fir. . .
eagle screeching out
into empty blue.*

*Yielding to supple wind,
each green fir dancing gracefully
with the Divine.*

*Clear autumn night. . .
high winds have scattered the stars
across the hollow sky.*



*For thirty years I have been
 in search of the Swordsman;
Many a time I have watched
 the leaves decay and the branches shoot;
Ever since I saw for once
 the peaches in bloom,
Not a shadow of a doubt
 do I cherish.*

--Ling Yun

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who showed me the Way of Haiku.*

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